

here. There is a Shivling, which is known as Kuleshwar Mahadev. According to legends, Lord Shri Ram had built these Shivlings from sand to worship Lord Shiva.

TURTURIYA

Turturiya is a small village located near Balukini mountain surrounded by dense forest area in Balodabazar district, 15 km from Kasdol on Ram Vanagaman Marg. According to legend, Maharishi Valmiki's ashram was here and it is believed that Turturia is the birthplace of Luv-Kush. Here the water of the river flows through the natural rocks with the sound of Turtur, due to which the place got its name Turturiya.

CHANDKHURI

Lord Shri Ram along with Mata Sita and Lakshman reached Arang-Chandkhuri via Sirpur, the ancient city situated on the banks of Mahanadi. There is Kaushalya Kund and ancient Bageshwar Shiva temple in Arang situated on the banks of Mahanadi. The village Chandkhuri, called Chandrapuri after the name of the Chandravanshiya kings, is situated at a distance of 27 kilometers from the capital Raipur. In this village with 126 ponds, India's only historical temple of Mata Kaushalya is located in the middle of Jalsen pond. The wonderful statue of mother Kaushalya holding son Ramchandra in her lap makes this temple rare and also because of this place, Chhattisgarh is considered to be the "Nanihal" of Lord Shri Ram.

SIHAWA

At a distance of 65 km from Dhamtari is Sihawa, a sacred place surrounded by dense forests and hills. This is the origin of Chhattisgarh's life-giving mythical Mahanadi. Shanta, the daughter of King Dasaratha, became the adopted daughter of King Rompad. Shanta was the sister of Lord Shriram who was married to Shringi Rishi. Shanta Gufa in the mountain next to Shringi Rishi Ashram in Sihawa is still present. *It was due to this relationship of Ramji's sister-brother-in-law with Sihawa, Lord Shri Ram spent most of his exile period in this place. This place was known as Jana Sthan in those days.* Due to the presence of Shringi Rishi's ashram here, it is called Sihawa. It is believed that King Dashrath had called Shringi Rishi from Sihawa to Ayodhya for Putreshti Yagya to get a son from his three queens and in the same Yagya, Mother Kaushalya gave birth to Lord Shri Ram.

JAGDALPUR

While going to the forest, Lord Shri Ram reached Chitrakot from Barsur, the capital of Banasura and from Barsur via Chhote Dongar. Chitrakot is considered to be an important stop of Ram Vanagaman in Bastar region. It is believed that at this place Lord Shiva-Parvati had come from Himgiri mountain to meet Lord Shri Ram. While going to the forest in Dandakaranya, Lord Shri Ram reached Jagdalpur, the main center of Dandakaranya via Chitrakot via Narayanapal to Indravati river route. The 5 kilometer long and 2 kilometer wide huge Dalpat reservoir located here gives the impression of a sea. From Jagdalpur via Geedam, reached Dantewada situated on the banks of river Shankhani and Dankani and then from Dantewada reached Tirathgarh situated on the banks of river Kanger. Here there is an ancient place called Sita Nahani. There is Tirathgarh and Darshani Falls. After spending some time in this picturesque place, reach Kotumbsar which is also known as Koti Maheshwar. It is said that Shri Ram worshiped Lord Shiva here during his exile. Many natural Shivlings are still present inside this cave.

RAMARAM

While visiting the Dandakaranya region, Shri Ram Chandra, on his way to Dakshinapath, reached a place which is known by his name after crossing the river route ahead of Kot Basar via Sukma. The name of this holy place is Ramaram. There is a legend of Shri Ram's footprint on the hill near this. It is also a legend that Shri Ram had worshiped Bhu-Devi here. Ramaram has the famous Chittamittin temple. This is the only place in the whole of Bastar where on the day of Ram Navami, the worship of its Aaradhya Devi is done with great enthusiasm. A huge fair is organized by the local residents on this occasion.

A GLIMPSE OF THE RAMAYANA CONTEXT IS SEEN IN THE ROCK PAINTINGS

A new beginning in taking Ram Katha to the masses through a different medium was made with those rock paintings which are seen in Ongana of Raigarh. There is a folk tradition here that Ramkatha is depicted in the hills of Ongana. Here a person with ten heads is shown fighting with a young man. It is believed that the person with ten heads is Ravana and the person fighting with him is Shri Ram. In this way, the seed of the artistic presentation of Ramkatha, which was planted by the rock painters in Ongna, will now have its special artistic presentation in the form of Ramayana Mahotsav. According to legends, the pictures made in these rock shelters of Ongana hill made thousands of years ago show the influence of Ramayana in the society of that time. The saga of Ramayana is being heard for generations. Its different forms are prevalent in different parts of the country. But the mention of Ramayana context in the form of archaeological remains is rare.





